

NPTEL ONLINE CERTIFICATION COURSES

Course Name: Employment Communication
- A Lab based course

Faculty Name: Dr Seema Singh
Department : Humanities & Social Sciences

Topic

Lecture 01: Introduction to Employment Communication
- A Lab based Course

Employment Communication - A Lab based course

CONCEPTS COVERED

Course Snapshot

**Eight Modules & Five tests
15 Practice Sessions & 25 Lectures
Eight Assignments & End Term Test**



Course Modules & Concepts covered:

Module I: Course Introduction & Verbal Communication

Module II: Non Verbal Communication & Cross Cultural Communication

Module III: Body Language & Listening Skills

Module IV: Introduction to CV Writing & How to write impressive CVs

Module V: How to write impressive CVs at later stages - CV writing stage II

Module VI: How to write the Cover Letter & Introduction to Group Discussions

Module VII: Introduction to Personal Interviews (PIs) &

Tackling difficult questions in PIs

Module VIII: Success in PIs & Course Wrap-up



Course Plan & Concepts Covered:

Module I: Course Introduction & Verbal Communication

1. Introduction to Employment Communication - A Lab based Course
2. Communication - An Introduction
3. Communication Skills at the Workplace
4. Verbal Communication - Introduction
5. Verbal Communication – contd.



Course Plan & Concepts Covered:

Module II: Non Verbal Communication & Cross Cultural Communication

6. Non Verbal Communication
7. Non Verbal Communication – contd.
8. Cross Cultural Communication
9. Cross Cultural Communication –contd.
10. Practice Session & Feedback



Course Plan & Concepts Covered:

Module III: Body Language & Listening Skills

- 11. Body Language - Introduction
- 12. Body Language – contd.
- 13. Listening Skills - Introduction
- 14. Listening Skills – contd.
- 15. Practice Session I & Feedback



Course Plan & Concepts Covered:

Module IV: Introduction to CV Writing & How to write impressive CVs

- 16. Practice Session II & Feedback
- 17. CV Writing - Introduction
- 18. CV Writing – contd.
- 19. How to write impressive CVs: Beginner / Fresher
- 20. Practice Session I & Feedback

Course Plan & Concepts Covered:

Module V: How to write impressive CVs at later stages in one's career - CV writing stage II

- 21. Practice Session II & Feedback
- 22. Practice Session III & Feedback
- 23. How to write impressive CVs at later stages in career: CV writing stage II
- 24. Practice Session I & Feedback
- 25. Practice Session II & Feedback



Course Plan & Concepts Covered:

Module VI: How to write the Cover Letter & Introduction to Group Discussions (GDs)

- 26. Practice Session III & Feedback
- 27. How to write the Cover Letter
- 28. Fundamentals of Group Discussions (GDs)
- 29. Strategies for Success in Group Discussions (GDs)
- 30. Practice Session I & Feedback



Course Plan & Concepts Covered:

Module VII: Introduction to Personal Interviews (PIs) & Tackling difficult questions in PIs

- 31. Practice Session II & Feedback
- 32. Practice Session III & Feedback
- 33. The Personal Interviews (PIs) - Introduction
- 34. Preparing for the Personal Interviews (PIs)
- 35. Tackling difficult questions in PIs

Course Plan & Concepts Covered:

Module VIII: Success in PIs & Course Wrap-up

36. Success in PIs

37. Practice Session I & Feedback

38. Practice Session II & Feedback

30. Practice Session III & Feedback

40. Course Wrap-up



References

Selected References:

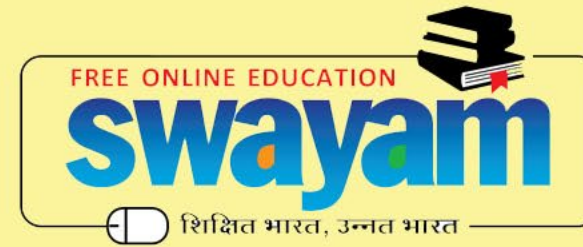
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2. *Managerial Communication: A Strategic Approach* – Smeltzer & Waltman, 1984
3. *Group Discussion: Theory & Technique* – Harnack, Fest and Jones
4. *The Art of Winning at Interviews* – Nagasudha Ravinuthala, 2005
5. *The Skills of Interviewing: A Guide for Managers and Trainers* – Leslie Rae, 2006
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Lecture 02: Communication - An Introduction

CONCEPTS COVERED

Communication – An Introduction

- The importance of communication
- What is Communication?
- How good a Communicator are you?
- Types of Communication
- Elements of Communication



Communication – An Introduction

CONCEPTS COVERED

- Six crucial characteristics of Communication
- Models of Communication
- Functions of Communication: What can it do for you?
- Communicating in a Digital Age
- Summary



Improving your effectiveness as a Communicator

- Becoming actively involved in the study of Communication
- Believe in yourself



What is Communication?

- The deliberate or accidental transfer of meaning
- Communication springs from the Latin verb *communicare* , which means “to make common”.
- Communication is the deepest core of our human selves.
- We cannot not communicate.

How good a Communicator are you?

We can all improve our communication skills

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Types of Communication

- Intrapersonal communication—communication with the self
- Interpersonal communication—relationship level of communication
- Group communication—interaction with a limited number of persons
- Public communication— communication designed to inform or persuade audience members

Types of Communication (contd.)

- Online, or machine-assisted communication—building of relationships using computers and the Internet
- Mass communication—transmission of messages which may be processed by gate keepers prior to being sent to large audiences via a channel of broad diffusion

Elements of Communication

Essentials of communication: elements present during every communication event

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Elements of Communication (Contd.)

1. People

- Senders—persons who formulate, encode, and transmit a message
- Receivers—persons who receive, decode and interpret a message

Elements of Communication (Contd.)

2. Messages—content of a communicative act
3. Channels—medium through which a message is sent
4. Noise—anything that interferes with or distorts the ability to send and receive messages
5. Context—setting

Elements of Communication (Contd.)

6. Feedback—information returned to a message source

- Positive feedback—behavior enhancing response
- Negative feedback—response that extinguishes behavior in progress

Elements of Communication (Contd.)

6. Feedback (continued)

- Internal feedback—response you give yourself
- External feedback—response from another

7. Effect—communication outcome

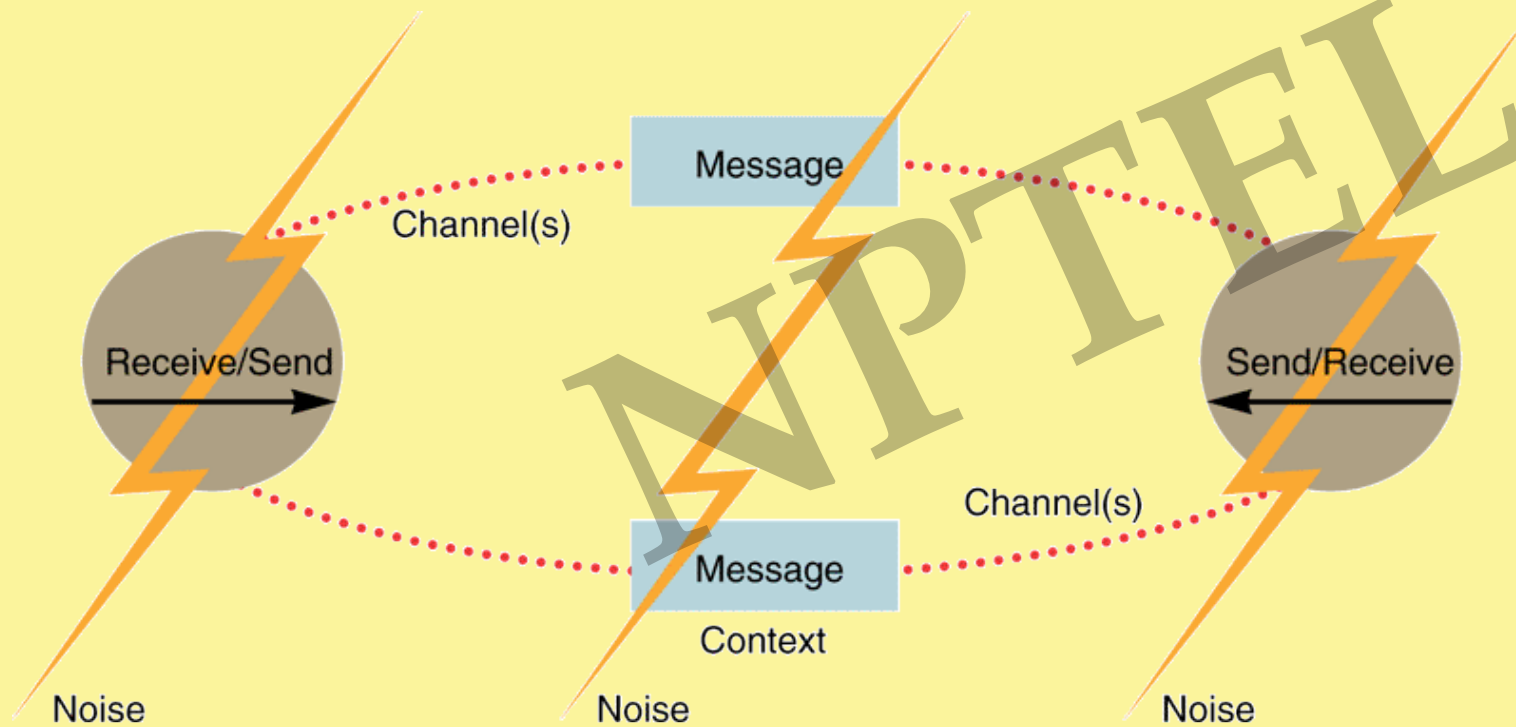
Communication Principles

- Dynamic
- Unrepeatable and irreversible
- Affected by culture
- Influenced by ethics
- Competence based
- Transformed by media and technology

Models of Communication

- Communication occurs whenever one person assigns significance or meaning to the behavior of another
- Gamble and Gamble's Model of Communication
 - Communication is a circle and the sending and receiving responsibilities are shared by the communicators

Gamble and Gamble's Model of Communication



Functions of Communication: What can it do for you?

- Understanding and Insight
 - Depend on communication to develop self-awareness



Functions of Communication: What can it do for you?

- **Meaningful Relationships**
 - Need for inclusion—the need for social contact
 - Need for control—the need to feel we are capable and responsible
 - Need for affection—the need to express and receive love



Functions of Communication: What can it do for you?

- Influence and Persuasion
 - Experiences with persuasion afford each of us the opportunity to influence others so that we may realize our own goals



Communication, the Media, and Technology

- Media and new technologies are altering the nature of our communication experiences
 - Cyberspace—the digital world of computers and online communication
 - Causing us to reexamine our relationships and redefine our notions of effective and meaningful communication



Communicating in a Digital Age

- Media Content Influences our Thoughts and Feelings
- Media and Computers Influence Our Perceptions of Communication



Summary

- Communication is the deliberate or accidental transfer of meaning
- Essential elements of communication are people, messages, channels, noise, context, feedback, and effect.
- Communication is a dynamic process, and each interaction is part of a series of interconnected communication events.
- Every communication experience is unique, unrepeatable, and irreversible.
- Communication serves a number of essential functions.
- Believe in Yourself



PIP for Faculty

References

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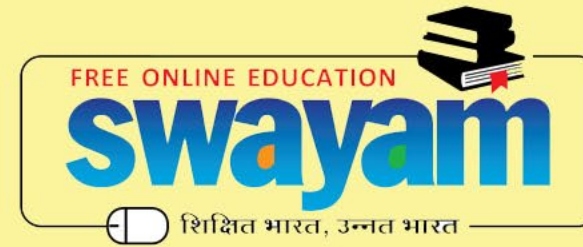
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2. Lesikar's Basic Business Communication - TMH
3. Bell and Smith's Management Communication – John Wiley
4. Gamble and Gamble's Communication Works - TMH





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Employment Communication – A Lab based course

Dr Seema Singh
Department of Humanities & Social Sciences
IIT Kharagpur

Topic

Lecture 03: Communication Skills at the Workplace

CONCEPTS COVERED

Why does Communication matter?

Basic purpose of Communication at the workplace



The importance of Communication Skills as expressed by Business authorities

“Top executives from Fortune 500 companies rate communications skills as the most important quality for business leaders.”
New York Times Business Section

“There may be no single thing more important in our efforts to achieve meaningful work and fulfilling relationships than to learn and practice the art of communication.”
The Art of Leadership
Max De Pree, Author



Evidence of Communication weakness(es) at workplaces

“I’m surprised how so many people struggle with communication.”

**- Michael Rook, Production Manager
Hewlett Packard, San Diego, CA**

“The first thing the Human Resources Department did was give me a writing book.”

**- Sam Reeves, IT Consultant
AMS, Denver, CO**



The role of Communication at the workplace

The importance of Communication Skills to you:

- Communication is important to business
- Business needs good communicators
- By improving your communication ability, you improve your chances for success.
- but most people do not communicate well



Why the need to communicate at the workplace

- Communication is vital to every part of business.
- Communication takes many forms: oral, written, and computer.
- All organized effort, including the work of business, requires communication.



Main forms of Communication at the workplace

There are three categories of Communication at the workplace:

- Operational
 - Internal
 - External
- Personal

Main forms of Communication at the workplace (contd.)

- (1) Internal operational—the communicating done in conducting work within a business, such as giving orders, assembling reports, and writing email.**
 - (2) External operational—work related communication with people outside the business, such as personal selling, telephoning, advertising, and writing messages.**
- Messages display a company's etiquette.
 - Both internal and external communications are vital to business success.

Main forms of Communication at the workplace (contd.)

3) Personal communication— non-business-related exchanges of information and feelings among people.

- **Personal communication affects employee attitudes.**
- **And attitudes affect employee performance.**
- **The extent of personal communication permitted affects employee attitudes.**

Communication networks at the workplace

- **Formal Network**
 - well-established, usually along operational lines
 - planned
- **Informal Network**
 - complex
 - dynamic

Factors affecting volume of Communication at the workplace

- Nature of the business
- Operating plan
- People

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Communication network of the Organization

- Information flow in a business forms a complex network.
- The flow is mainly downward, but upward communication is also important.
- The main (formal) lines of flow are like the network of arteries in the body.

The Informal network

- The secondary (informal) network is like the veins.
- This secondary network is highly complex and continually changing.
- Managers can use this network (the grapevine) effectively.

Variation in Communication activity at workplaces

- The extent of workplace communication depends on the nature of the business, its operating plan, its geographic dispersion, and the people involved.

How Oral and Written Communication differ

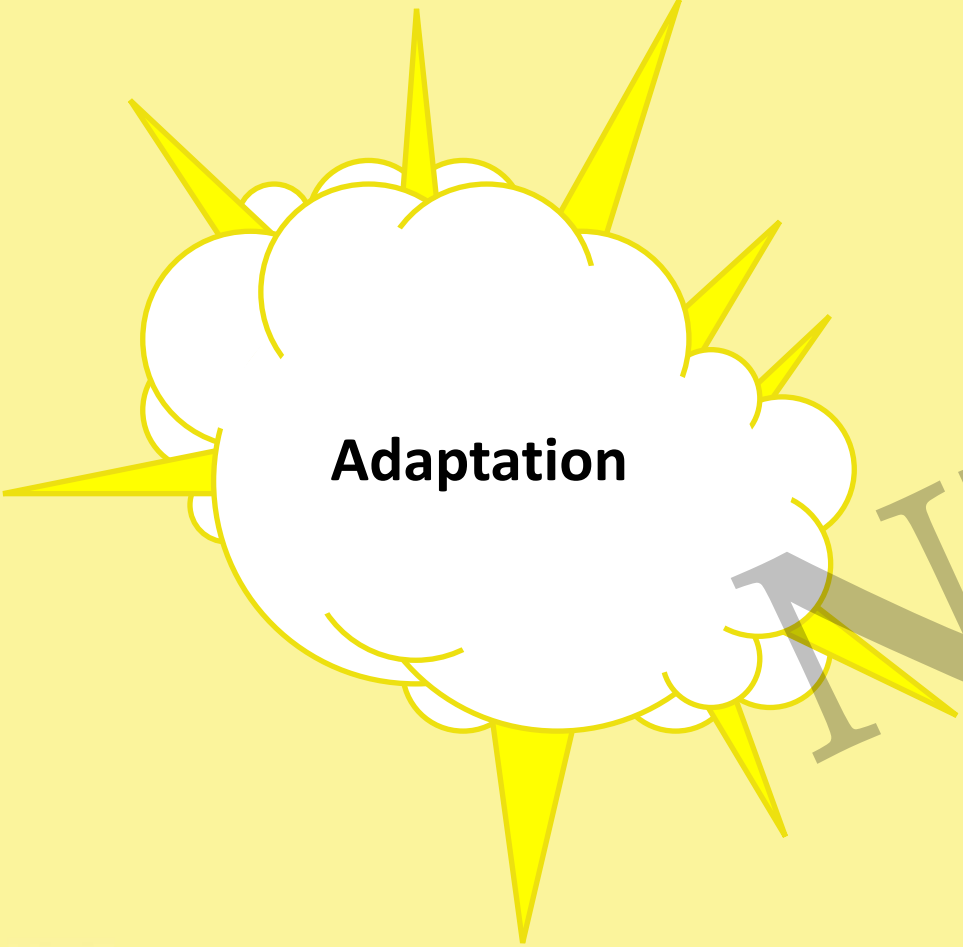
Written communication differs from oral communication in that it:

- (1) is more likely to involve creative effort,
- (2) has longer cycles, and
- (3) usually has fewer cycles.

Some basic truths about Communication

- The communication process reveals some basic truths.
- Meanings sent are not always received: Because our mental filters differ, meanings sent may differ from meanings received.
- Meaning is in the mind: Meanings are in the mind—not in symbols.
- The symbols of Communication are imperfect: Because symbols are imperfect and people differ in their ability to communicate, communication is far from perfect.
- Communication across cultures is especially difficult.
- Even so, we communicate reasonably well.

Resulting stress on adaptation



Adaptation

The communication process shows the need for adaptation— an underlying principle in our study of communication.

“Writing is thinking on paper. Anyone who thinks clearly should be able to write clearly about any subject at all.”

**- William Zinsser, Author
*On Writing Well***



Summary by Lecture objectives

1. Business needs and rewards people who can communicate, for communication is vital to business operations.
 - But good communicators are scarce.
 - So, if you can improve your communication skills, you increase your value to business and business will reward you.

Summary by Lecture objectives (contd.)

2. Communicating in business falls into three categories:

- The communicating a business does to implement its operating plan (its procedure for doing what it was formed to do) is called *internal-operational* communication.
- The communicating a business does with outsiders (suppliers, other businesses, customers, and such) is called *external-operational communication*.
- Informal exchanges of information not related to operations are called *personal* communication.

Summary by Lecture objectives (contd.)

3. The flow of communication in a business organization forms a complex and ever-changing network. Information continually flows from person to person— upward, downward, and laterally.
- The communicating that follows the formal structure of the business forms the *formal network*. Primarily, operational information flows through this network.
 - The flow of personal communication forms the *informal network*.

Summary by Lecture objectives (contd.)

The communication process reveals these truths:

- Meanings sent are not always received (our mental filters differ).
- Meaning is in the mind—not in the symbols (mainly words) used.
- The symbols we use are imperfect, primarily because the reality they describe is so complex.



References

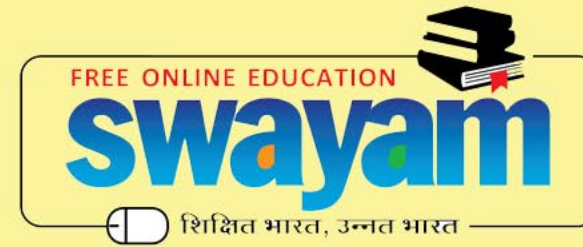
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Employment Communication - A Lab based course

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**Department of Humanities & Social Sciences
IIT Kharagpur**

Topic

Lecture 04: Verbal Communication - Introduction

Language and Meaning: Helping minds meet

CONCEPTS COVERED



Language and Meaning: Helping minds meet

CONCEPTS COVERED

- What Language is
- How Language works: Words, things and thoughts
- The Communication of meaning
- Culture and Language
- Gender and Language



Language and Meaning: Helping minds meet

CONCEPTS COVERED

- Language and Power
- Problems with meaning: Patterns of miscommunication
- Thinking critically about Language: How to make Language work for you



Language and Meaning: Helping minds meet

CONCEPTS COVERED

- Technology and Language use
- Guidelines for developing Language Skills
- Summary



What Language is

- Language—unified system of symbols that permits the sharing of meaning
- Symbol—represents or stands for something else

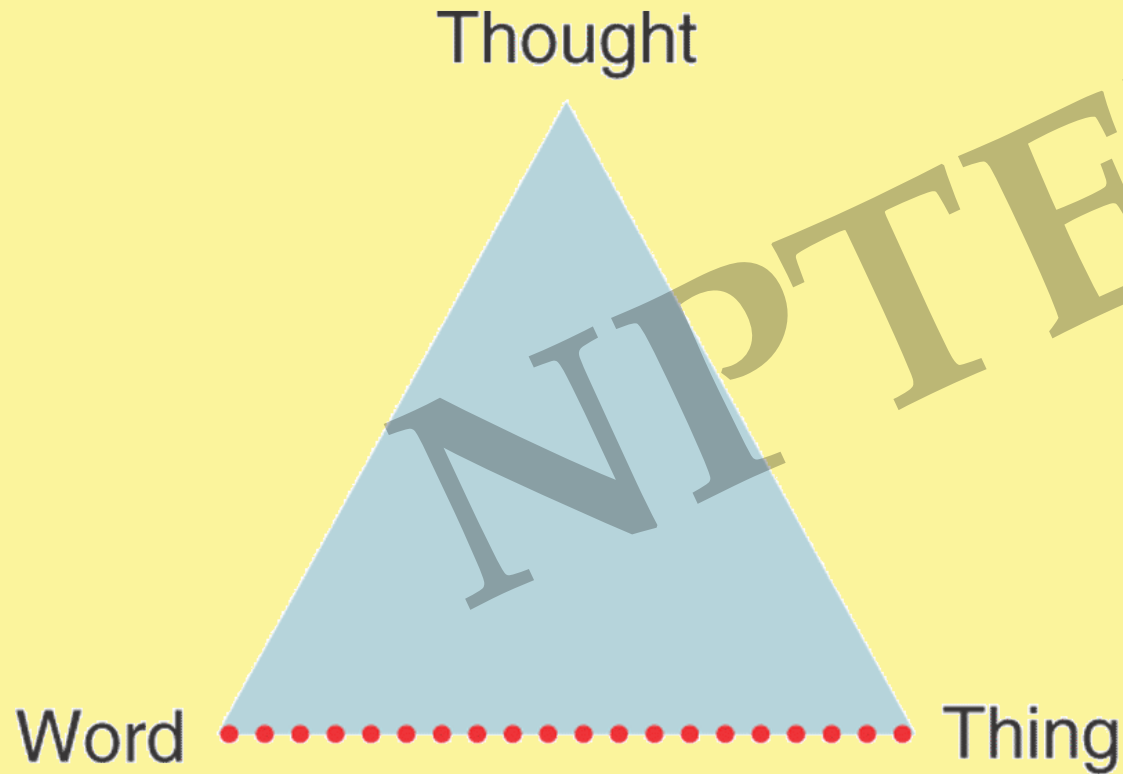
How Language works: Words, things, & thoughts

Triangle of meaning—explains the relationship which exists between words, things, and thoughts

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Triangle of Meaning



The Communication of meaning

- Meanings are Denotative and Connotative
 - Denotative meaning—dictionary meaning; the objective or descriptive meaning of a word
 - Connotative meaning—subjective meaning; one's personal meaning for a word

The Communication of meaning (contd.)

- Meanings are Denotative and Connotative (continued)
 - Meaning and Time
 - Meaning and Place
 - Meaning and Experience
- Whether language is concrete or abstract influences meaning

Culture and Language

Culture influences the words used

- Dominant culture—culture in power; the mainstream culture
- Co-cultures—sub-culture; a group of people who have a culture of their own outside of the dominant culture

Culture and Language (contd.)

The Sapir-Whorf Hypothesis

- Sapir-Whorf hypothesis—belief that the labels we use help shape the way we think, our worldview, and behavior
 - Linguistic determinism—belief that language influences how we interpret the world
 - Linguistic relativity—belief that persons who speak different languages perceive the world differently

Culture and Language (contd.)

- Cultural differences can lead to confused translations
- Culture influences Communication style

Culture and Language (contd.)

Prejudiced talk

- Linguistic prejudice—use of prejudiced language
- Prejudiced language—language which communicates a negative bias

Culture and Language (contd.)

- Culture and Globalization influence the Language used
- Hip Hop and Rap Talk

Gender and Language

- Sexism in Language
- Gender and speech style
 - Qualifiers—tentative phrases
 - Tag questions—question between an outright statement and a yes/no question
 - Disclaimers—remarks which diminish a statement's importance

Gender and Language (contd.)

Gender-lects—Deborah Tannen's term for language differences attributed to gender

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Language and Power

Men and women have the potential to influence the way others perceive them by communicating in ways that make them appear more

- Confident
- Forceful
- In control of a situation

Language and Power (contd.)

Men and women have the potential to influence the way others perceive them by communicating in ways that make them appear more

- Confident
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Problems with meaning: Patterns of miscommunication

Bypassing: confusing meanings

- Bypassing—occurs when individuals think they understand each other, but actually miss each other's meaning

Problems with meaning: Patterns of miscommunication (contd.)

- Evasive and Emotive Language
 - Euphemism—substitution of a pleasant word in place of a less pleasant one
- Politically correct language
- Profanity and obscenity: Incivility and the coarsening of Language

Thinking critically about Language: How to make Language work for you

- A call for common sense
- A call for clarity

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Technology and Language use

- Onlinespeak—the protocol of informality that marks electronic communication
- Netiquette—rules of the Internet



Guidelines for developing Language Skills

- Identify how labels affect your behavior
- Identify how the words you use affect your feelings and attitudes
 - Snarl words—words with highly negative connotations
 - Purr words—words with highly positive connotations

Guidelines for developing Language Skills (contd.)

- Identify how experience can affect meaning
- Be sure that meanings are shared

Summary

- Language is a unified system of symbols that permits a sharing of meaning.
- No direct relationship between words and things.

Summary

- A serious barrier to communication occurs when we forget the fact that words have both generally agreed-to denotative meanings and highly individualized connotative meanings.

Summary

- Culture and gender influence the ways men and women experience, process and use language.
- Language influences the attitudes we hold about males and females, as well as how males and females perceive each other.

Summary

- Among the communication problems that result from changes in meaning are bypassing and mistaking a label for the thing itself.
- Use common sense to recognize that certain styles of language are appropriate at certain times and in certain places.

Summary

- Make ourselves as clear as possible by selecting words with meaning for our listeners.
- How we communicate online frequently differs from how we communicate in person.

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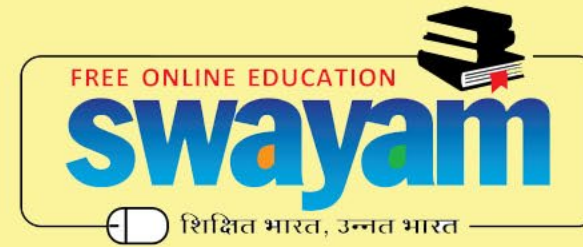
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